

【9.18 | Economist】Silicon dunes 硅丘

难度评级: ★★★★★☆

【考研那些事儿之商业系列】

今日文章脉络:

海湾地区虽局势不稳，但数据中心建设从未停止 (Para. 1)



甚至更多公司相继宣布在此投资建设更多数据中心 (Para. 2)



美国大规模云厂商也仍积极与阿联酋合作 (Para. 3)



此次建设潮不受战争阻挡的原因:

低廉的能源和土地 (Para. 4)



海湾地区 AI 人才净流入居全球首列 (Para. 5)



该地区资金雄厚也是原因之一 (Para. 6)



海湾国家对数据中心及其使用的政策要求 (Para. 7)



海湾地区几乎没有公众反对数据中心，
而美国则很多 (Para. 8)



战争扰乱了海湾地区经济繁荣，
也坚定了其保障数字投资的决心 (Para. 9)

War has not **halted** the Gulf's data-centre boom

战争未能阻挡海湾地区的数据中心热潮

【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析~】

【Para.1】

Soon after war **broke out** in the Gulf, Iranian **drones** targeted Amazon's data centres in the United Arab Emirates (UAE) and Bahrain. But at Stargate UAE, a 1-**gigawatt** data centre being built on a 5GW campus in Abu Dhabi, work “never stopped,” says an executive at a state-backed artificial-intelligence firm. The first 200-megawatt phase is almost complete.

- **dune** n. /du:n/ a small hill of sand formed by the wind, near the sea or in a desert (风吹积成的) 沙丘
- **halt** v. to stop; to make sb/sth stop (使) 停止，停下 【考研大纲词汇】

The trial was halted after the first week. 第一周结束后，审判暂停。

- **break out** *phrase* if something such as war, fighting, or disease breaks out, it begins suddenly (战争、殴斗、疾病等) 爆发

He was 29 when war broke out. 战争爆发时他 29 岁。

- **drone** n. /drəʊn/ an aircraft without a pilot, controlled from

the ground 无人驾驶飞机

- **gigawatt n.** /'gɪgə,wɒt/ 吉瓦, 千兆瓦, 十亿瓦特

海湾地区战事爆发后不久, 伊朗无人机便将亚马逊位于阿联酋(UAE)和巴林的数据中心列为打击目标。但在“星际之门阿联酋”(Stargate UAE), 据一位某国资人工智能公司的高管表示, 建设工作“从未停止”。该在建项目位于阿布扎比一个 5 吉瓦园区内, 落成后会是一座 1 吉瓦数据中心。目前首期 200 兆瓦阶段已接近完工。

【Para.2】

Last year PwC, a consultancy, predicted that across the Gulf data-centre capacity would rise **fourfold** within five years, to about 4GW. The outbreak of war has not halted the boom. HUMAIN, an AI company established by Saudi Arabia's **sovereign-wealth fund**, announced last month that it would build a facility with DataVolt, another Saudi firm, at Oxagon, an industrial city on the country's west coast. Two other Saudi **outfits**, Axelerated Solutions and Al Moammar Information Systems, have also **trumpeted** new data-centre investments.

- **fourfold adv.** /'fɔːfəʊld/ by or up to four times as many or as much 四倍地
- **sovereign-wealth fund n.** /'sɒvrɪn/ a state-owned investment fund 主权财富基金(一种国家拥有的投资基金)
- **outfit n.** /'aʊtfɪt/ a group of people working together as an

organization, business, team, etc.团队；小组；分队 【考研大纲词汇】

a market research outfit 市场调查组

- **trumpet** v. /'trʌmpɪt/ ~ sth (as sth) to talk about sth publicly in a proud or enthusiastic way 宣扬；鼓吹；吹嘘 【考研大纲词汇】

to trumpet sb's achievements 吹嘘某人的成就

去年，咨询机构普华永道预测，整个海湾地区的数据中心容量将在五年内扩大至四倍，达到约 4 吉瓦。战事爆发并未遏止这一热潮。由沙特主权财富基金设立的人工智能公司 HUMAIN 上月宣布，将与另一家沙特企业 DataVolt 合作，在沙特西海岸工业城市奥克萨贡共建一座数据中心。另外两家沙特公司 Axelerated Solutions 和 Al Moammar Information Systems 也高调公布了新的数据中心投资。

【Para.3】

America's **hyperscalers**, too, seem to have lost none of their enthusiasm. In September Amazon Web Services said it was expanding a partnership with HUMAIN to provide more data-centre capacity by 2028. Last month Microsoft, which has **leased** Saudi sites from Al Moammar and is working with Du, an Emirati telecom firm, to build a data centre in the UAE, said it would bring more regional capacity online in November.

- **hyperscaler** n. /'haɪpərˌskeɪlər/ 超大规模云服务商：指拥有

极大规模的数据中心和基础设施，能够向客户提供海量算力、存储及云服务的顶尖科技巨头

- **lease v.** ~ sth (from sb), ~ sth (out) (to sb) to use or let sb use sth, especially property or equipment, in exchange for rent or a regular payment 租用，租借，出租（尤指房地产或设备）【考研大纲词汇】

They lease the land from a local farmer. 他们从当地一位农场主手中租得这块土地。

美国超大规模云厂商似乎同样热情不减。9月，亚马逊云服务表示，正在扩大与 HUMAIN 的合作，以期在 2028 年前提供更多数据中心容量。上月，微软表示将于 11 月启用更多区域容量；该公司已从 Al Moammar 租用沙特站点，并正与阿联酋电信企业 Du 合作，在阿联酋建设数据中心。

【Para.4】

Several factors explain the region's continued attraction, despite the conflict. One is cheap energy: electricity **tariffs** in the Gulf are around six cents per kilowatt hour, compared with between nine and 15 cents in America, reports PwC. Vast amounts of renewable power and new transmission infrastructure have pushed costs lower. Another is cheap land: according to PwC, industrial land for data centres in Saudi Arabia costs \$10-50 per square metre, **well** below the \$150-600 in northern Virginia, where many of America's server farms live. McKinsey, another

consultancy, puts the cost of building and powering a 100-megawatt AI data centre in the Gulf at \$200-220 per MW hour, nearly as low as in China.

- **tariff n.** /'tærɪf/ a list of fixed prices that are charged by a hotel or restaurant for rooms, meals, etc., or by a company for a particular service (旅馆、饭店或服务公司的) 价目表, 收费表 【考研大纲词汇】
- **well adv.** to a great extent or degree 很; 相当; 大大地; 远远地 【考研大纲词汇】

a well-loved tale 深受喜爱的故事

The castle is well worth a visit. 这座城堡很值得参观。

尽管战争冲突持续, 该地区仍具吸引力, 原因有几点。其一是能源价格低廉: 普华永道报告称, 海湾地区电价约为每千瓦时 6 美分, 而美国为 9 至 15 美分。大量可再生能源和新输电基础设施进一步压低了成本。其二是土地价格低廉: 据普华永道数据, 沙特数据中心工业用地价格为每平方米 10 至 50 美元, 远低于美国北弗吉尼亚州的 150 至 600 美元, 美国许多服务器集群便坐落于此。另一家咨询机构麦肯锡估算, 在海湾地区建设和供电一座 100 兆瓦人工智能数据中心, 成本为每兆瓦时 200 至 220 美元, 低到几乎与中国相当。

【Para.5】

The Gulf has also established itself as a **hub** for industry talent: last year the UAE and Saudi Arabia were among the countries that recorded the

highest net **inflow** of AI workers relative to their workforces. There is no evidence that war has sent this flow of talent into **reverse**.

- **hub n.** ~ (of sth) the central and most important part of a particular place or activity (某地或活动的) 中心, 核心
the commercial hub of the city 城市的商业中心
- **inflow n.** the movement of a lot of money, people or things into a place from somewhere else (资金、人或事物的) 流入, 涌入

SYN influx

The Swiss wanted to discourage an inflow of foreign money. 瑞士人想要阻止外资流入。

- **reverse v.** to change sth completely so that it is the opposite of what it was before 颠倒; 彻底转变; 使完全相反
【考研大纲词汇】

to reverse a procedure/process/trend 彻底改变程序/过程/趋势

The government has failed to reverse the economic decline.
政府未能扭转经济滑坡的趋势。

海湾地区还确立了其行业人才中心的地位: 去年, 阿联酋和沙特阿拉伯的人工智能人才净流入量 (相对于其劳动力规模而言) 位于全球前列。而且, 目前没有证据表明, 战事已使这一人才流入趋势发生逆转。

【Para.6】

Then there are the Gulf states' **deep pockets**. In July MGX, an Emirati state-run fund, raised \$50bn to invest in AI. Most of that money will flow to overseas companies, but those wanting a slice of it will be eager to keep their **paymasters** happy by investing in the region.

- **deep pocket** *phrase* a source of substantial wealth (usually plural) 深口袋: 拥有大量财力的个人或组织; 也可指雄厚的财力或财源
- **paymaster** n. a person or group of people that pays another person or organization and therefore can control their actions 操纵者; 后台老板

此外，海湾国家财力雄厚。7月，阿联酋国有基金 MGX 筹集 500 亿美元用于投资人工智能。其中大部分资金将流向海外企业，但希望从中分一杯羹的企业，将急于通过在该地区投资来让出资方满意。

【Para.7】

Domestic policies in the Gulf will require more data centres, in effect **underwriting** demand. In April the UAE said it would **deploy** “agentic AI” across half of the government. The country’s National Cloud Security Policy requires “operational sovereignty” for government entities and operators of critical infrastructure, further supporting the build-out, while Saudi Arabia’s financial institutions are generally required to use cloud services within the country. Luca Bennici of McKinsey notes that private

firms in the Gulf have “growing concerns” of their own about data protection and **sovereignty**.

- **underwrite v.** to accept financial responsibility for an activity so that you will pay for special costs or for losses it may make 承担经济责任（包括支付特别费用或损失）

The government will have to create a special agency to underwrite small business loans. 政府将不得不建立一个专门机构来为小额企业贷款提供担保。

- **deploy v.** to move soldiers or weapons into a position where they are ready for military action 部署，调度（军队或武器）

2 000 troops were deployed in the area.那个地区部署了 2 000 人的部队。

- **sovereignty n.** /'sɒvrənti/ ~ (over sth)complete power to govern a country 主权；最高统治权；最高权威

The country claimed sovereignty over the island.那个国家声称对该岛拥有主权。

the sovereignty of Parliament 议会的最高权威

- **build-out phrase** an urban planner' s estimate of the amount and location of potential development for an area 增建，扩建

海湾国家的国内政策将需要更多数据中心，这实际上为需求提供了担保。4 月，阿联酋表示将在半数政府部门部署“代理式人工智能”。该国《国家云安全政策》要求政府实体和关

键基础设施运营者实现“运营主权”，这进一步支撑了数据中心扩建；沙特阿拉伯的金融机构则普遍被要求使用境内云服务。麦肯锡的卢卡·本尼奇（Luca Bennici）指出，海湾地区私营企业对数据保护和主权问题“的担忧在日益加剧”。

【Para.8】

What is more, there is little of the public opposition to data centres increasingly on show in the West, where many people **resent** power-hungry facilities **on their doorstep**. **Bashing** data centres has turned into a popular campaign strategy in American politics. In the Gulf, not so much. “Centralised decision making” helps, says an executive in the region.

- **resent v.** /rɪˈzent/ to feel bitter or angry about sth, especially because you feel it is unfair 愤恨；感到气愤；愤愤不平【考研大纲词汇】

I deeply resented her criticism. 我对她的批评感到非常气愤。

- **on the/sb's doorstep** *phrase* very close to where a person lives 在某人的住所旁

The nightlife is great with bars and clubs right on the doorstep. 有这些酒吧和夜总会位于家门口，夜生活真是棒极了。

- **bash v.** /bæʃ/ to criticize sb/sth strongly 严厉批评

Bashing politicians is normal practice in the press. 严厉批判政治人物乃是新闻界常事。

更重要的是，西方公众针对数据中心的反对日益显现，许多

人对住所附近的高耗能设施感到不满, 但这种情况在海湾地区却很少见。抨击数据中心已在美国政治成为一种流行的竞选策略。在海湾地区则不然。该地区一位高管表示, 这得益于“集中决策”。

【Para.9】

True, the war has disrupted the Gulf's carefully **crafted** economic boom. It has also made the region's rulers more determined to make their digital investments secure. Kurt Davis junior of Alvarez & Marsal, one more consultancy, notes that plans to make data centres as safe as **embassies**, even putting them underground, are being **mooted**. Nevertheless, the build-out continues.

- **craft v.** to make sth using special skills, especially with your hands (尤指用手工) 精心制作 【考研大纲词汇】

All the furniture is crafted from natural materials. 所有的家具均采用天然材料精心制作而成。

a carefully crafted speech 精心准备的讲话

- **embassy n.** /'embəsi/ the building in which an embassy works 大使馆 (指馆舍)

a demonstration outside the Russian Embassy 在俄罗斯大使馆外的示威游行

- **moot v.** /mu:t/ to suggest an idea for people to discuss 提出...供讨论

SYN propose, put forward

Plans have been mooted for a 450,000-strong army. 建立一支拥有 45 万士兵的大军的计划被提出供讨论。

诚然，战争扰乱了海湾地区精心打造的经济繁荣。但战争也使该地区的执政者更加坚定地要保障其数字投资的安全。另一家咨询机构 Alvarez & Marsal 的小库尔特·戴维斯（Kurt Davis junior）指出，计划将数据中心打造得如使馆般安全、甚至将其设于地下的方案正在酝酿中。尽管如此，数据中心扩建仍在继续。

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➤ 今日翻译作业

(Para. 8) What is more, there is little of the public opposition to data centres increasingly on show in the West, where many people resent power-hungry facilities on their doorstep.

（下一页提供句子分析）

➤ 今日句子分析

Para 8. What is more, there is little of the public opposition to data centres increasingly on show in the West, where many people resent power-hungry facilities on their doorstep. 更重要的是, 西方公众针对数据中心的反对日益显现, 许多人对住所附近的高耗能设施感到不满, 但这种情况在海湾地区却很少见。

主句

What is more, there is little of the public opposition

(连接性状语) 主语 谓 (真正主语)

to data centres increasingly on show in the West,

定语

定语

定语从句

where many people resent power-hungry facilities

引导词

主语

谓语

宾语

on their doorstep.

状语

句子分析:

主句：

连接性状语-What is more,; 形式主语- there; 谓语- is

(there is: 存在句结构)

真正主语，也是真正主语的中心词，表示“几乎没有”，是否

定意义-little ; 定语，修饰 little-of the public opposition;

定语，说明反对对象是数据中心- to data centres;

定语，修饰 opposition- increasingly on show in the West

(on show “正在上演/展出” 整理用来指 “(某种现象) 正

在显现”，例：A tougher Mr Obama may be on show in

2011. 2011 年奥巴马可能会显示出更加强硬的态度。) ;

定语从句，修饰 the West:

引导词-where; 主语- many people; 谓语- resent ; 宾语-

power-hungry facilities; 状语- on their doorstep.

翻译解析：整体结构可以简化为：There is little of （西方日

益显现的那种公众对数据中心的反对），there 指的是前面提

到的海湾地区，这里很多同学容易误解为西方很少公众反对，

实际上 the public opposition...increasingly on show in the

West, 西方的反对声音日益增加。如果是西方反对声音少, 英文应该是 In the West, there is little public opposition. 在西方, 公众反对很少。

where 从句修饰 the West, where many people resent power-hungry facilities on their doorstep 在西方, 许多人对家门口的高耗能设施感到不满。这个从句进一步说明: 西方确实存在明显的公众反对。

power-hungry 通常可指人“权欲熏心的”, 但这里修饰 facilities, 意思是“耗电巨大的、电力饥渴的”。

➤ 写作积累

Para.4 Several factors **explain** the region' s continued attraction, **despite** the conflict.

这个句子的写法可以参考，尤其是议论文。相较于 there are several reasons behind...等常见句式，explain 这个动词（解释.....）可以化被动为主动，更简洁地引出下文将要列举的因素，类似例句：scientific findings that help explain the origins of the universe 有助于解释宇宙起源的科学发现。

而后的 despite 则是介词，后可以直接跟名词或动名词，跟 in spite of 几乎可以互用，类似例句：Her voice was shaking despite all her efforts to control it.尽管她竭尽全力控制自己，声音仍然在颤抖。

但需注意 despite 不可直接跟 that 从句，往往会跟名词+同位语从句搭配出现，例如：She was good at physics despite the fact that she found it boring.尽管她认为物理枯燥无味，她却学得很好。

Para.5 The Gulf has also **established itself as** a hub for industry talent:

establish oneself as 是一个固定搭配, 意为 “使自己确立为...../使自己成为.....”, 例: By then she was established as a star.

那时她作为明星的地位已经确立。

后跟的 as 是作为补语存在, 引出主语确立的身份/地位。